

MAY 11

Kennedy dispatches 400 Special Forces personnel (Green Berets) to South Vietnam and authorizes covert operations.



Green Beret headgear

JUNE 4

At a summit meeting in Vienna, President Kennedy and Soviet Leader Nikita Khrushchev approve a plan for a neutralist Laos.

JULY 1

General Maxwell Taylor is appointed as Kennedy's special military adviser on Vietnam.

NOVEMBER 22

Kennedy authorizes a major escalation of American involvement in South Vietnam, including the dispatch of military helicopters and aircrew to fly them into combat.

DECEMBER 31

At the year's end, there are 3,200 US military personnel in South Vietnam. The American death toll for the year is 16.